

Poppets and fetishes

Dolls used in magic include poppets—which are effigies made to look like a particular person—and fetishes—objects thought to be inhabited by spirits, which give them powers to protect or punish. The idea is that the practitioner performs actions on the doll, such as sticking in nails or pins to inflict injury, which they wish to happen to the person. Some dolls protect the community rather than targeting an individual.

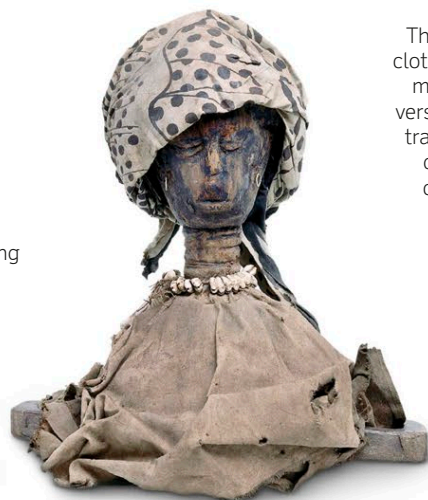
◀ **Dolls** such as this Sioux example have long been a part of Native American culture, as toys, guides to the spirit world, and to ensure good harvests.



The doll is dressed in Inuit clothing



▲ **Modern corn dollies** have revived the craft of straw plaiting. For centuries in Europe, it was believed that harvesting corn made the spirit of the grain homeless, so the last sheath cut was made into a doll for it to inhabit in the winter.



▲ **Witches' effigies** believed to have magical properties were, like Voodoo dolls, made to symbolize an individual. The maker could then use the effigy to influence the person's life.



The doll is clothed in a miniature version of a traditional deerskin costume

▲ **Canadian Inuit dolls** like this bird-headed example were used during rituals by sacred healers to represent spirits and help the healer enter the spiritual realm.